

“India expected to become self-sufficient in metals”

Non-Executive Chairman, Vedanta Limited & Founder, Vedanta Group, on the historic demerger, the vision for the company, and more

BY KRISHNA GOPALAN

T

There must be a handful of countries that Anil Agarwal has not visited but his favourite place remains *aamchi* (our) Mumbai. In his expansive home in South Mumbai's Colaba, just around the corner of two bustling landmarks—the Gateway of India and the Taj Mahal Hotel—Agarwal is unusually calm after months of hard work that culminated in a successful restructuring of the group into five distinct entities.

Dressed in a suit and slip-ons, he gently moves around in the large sofa.

The conversation slips in and out of business. With a slight smile, he picks out key events from the past, links them to the present, and attempts to paint the future. Through all this, he does not even pause for a glass of water. In earthy Hindi laced with humour and common sense, Agarwal makes his point clear; that for his group, India is where the action is.

Agarwal, who came to Mumbai from Patna in the mid-1970s with a box and a dream, has been seen the natural resources story up and personal. That ability to grasp the global picture and then determine a business opportunity in India can come only from years of experience. At 72, the Non-Executive Chairman, Vedanta Limited & Founder of Vedanta Group, is excited about how much more the company can do. Excerpts from a conversation with *Business Today*:

Q: What makes this moment so important for Vedanta?

A: This is a victory for everyone. Today, the whole world is looking at India very positively. Nothing is